

SALESFORCE PLATFORM DOCUMENTATION

AgentExchange User Manual

A Complete Guide for Customers, Administrators, and Publishing Partners

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Document Control

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0.5	2026-08-02	Mary Langley	Added partner publishing guide; incorporated AgentExchange rebrand terminology
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DOCUMENT INFORMATION

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1. Introduction

AgentExchange is Salesforce's unified marketplace for discovering, purchasing, and deploying digital solutions across the Salesforce and Slack ecosystems. It consolidates three marketplaces that previously operated separately — AppExchange, the Slack Marketplace, and the Agentforce component ecosystem — into a single destination where customers can find apps, AI agents, prebuilt components, and consulting services from vetted Salesforce partners.

The platform serves two distinct populations, and this manual is organized to serve both:

- **Customers and administrators**, who use AgentExchange to browse, evaluate, install, and manage third-party solutions inside their Salesforce orgs or Slack workspaces.
- **Partners** (independent software vendors and consulting firms), who use AgentExchange to package, publish, and distribute their own solutions to the broader customer base.

AgentExchange reflects a broader shift in how organizations extend Salesforce: beyond static applications, the marketplace now supports composable, agent-ready building blocks — Actions, Topics, Prompt Templates, and Agent Templates — that plug directly into Agentforce Builder, in addition to traditional managed packages, Bolt solutions, Flow solutions, and Lightning data offerings.

NOTE

This manual describes general platform behavior current as of August 2026. Because AgentExchange launched under active development following its rebrand from AppExchange, some screen names, permission labels, and console layouts may shift between releases. Always confirm current behavior against Salesforce's official Application Installation Guide and ISVforce Guide before relying on this manual for a production rollout.

2. Getting Started

2.1 Accessing AgentExchange

AgentExchange is available as a public web marketplace and is also surfaced contextually inside the Salesforce product itself:

- **Public marketplace** — accessible to anyone at the AgentExchange website, without requiring a Salesforce login, for browsing and evaluating listings.
- **In-product discovery** — accessible from within Agentforce Builder, allowing admins and builders to find and attach agentic components without leaving their build workflow.
- **Partner Console** — a separate, authenticated workspace for partners managing their own listings, packages, and analytics.

2.2 Roles and Permissions Overview

Access to AgentExchange functionality is governed by a small set of permissions layered on top of standard Salesforce and Slack administrative roles. The table below summarizes who can do what; a full reference appears in Appendix B.

Activity	Who Can Perform It
Browse and test-drive listings	Anyone (no authentication required)
Install a package into a Salesforce org	Salesforce admins, or any user with the Download AgentExchange Packages permission
Install a solution into a Slack workspace	Slack workspace admins
Create a publishable package	Partner users with the Create AgentExchange Packages permission
Upload/publish a package listing	Partner users with the Upload AgentExchange Packages permission

TIP

Publishing a listing requires both the Create and Upload permissions together — a user with only one of the two cannot complete the publishing flow. Confirm both are assigned before a partner team begins onboarding.

2.3 Key Terminology

Term	Definition
Listing	The public-facing marketplace entry for a solution, including its description, demo, reviews, and install/buy action.
Package	The underlying technical artifact (managed package, Bolt solution, Flow solution, agent bundle, etc.) that gets installed into a customer's environment.
2GP (Second-Generation Packaging)	Salesforce's recommended packaging format for new AgentExchange solutions, supporting versioning and modular deployment.
Action	A discrete task an agent can perform — built from Apex, Flow, or an external API call — that extends what an Agentforce agent is able to do.
Topic	A grouping of related actions and instructions that keeps an agent focused on a specific job and within defined guardrails. Renamed Subagent in Salesforce's Agent Script docs starting April 2026; see Section 12 for detail.
Prompt Template	A reusable, pre-written prompt structure that standardizes how an agent gathers information or responds in a given scenario.
Agent Template	A bundled solution combining multiple topics, actions, and global instructions into a ready-to-deploy agent configuration.
Partner Console	The authenticated workspace where partners manage org connections, packages, and listings.
Test Drive	A read-only, fully functional demo environment that lets a prospective customer evaluate a solution before installing it.

PART I

Customer & Administrator Guide

Everything an admin or end user needs to discover, evaluate, install, and manage AgentExchange solutions inside a Salesforce org or Slack workspace.

3. Discovering Solutions

AgentExchange supports three ways to evaluate a solution before committing to it, designed to let teams de-risk adoption without provisioning a full trial org.

3.1 Browse

Anyone can search and filter AgentExchange listings by category, industry, product line, or pricing model. Each listing displays a description, customer reviews, screenshots, and — where available — a recorded or interactive demo.

3.2 Test Drive

Many listings offer a test drive: a live, read-only version of the solution that a prospective customer can explore without installing anything. This is intended for evaluation and planning conversations between end users and their admins, not for production use.

3.3 Search from Within Agentforce Builder

Admins building agents directly in Agentforce Builder can search AgentExchange without switching tools, making it possible to find and evaluate a component (an action, topic, or template) at the exact point where it would be used. See Section 8 for details.

NOTE

Browsing and test-driving a listing does not require any AgentExchange-specific permission. Installation is the first step that requires admin-level access.

4. Preparing to Install a Package

Before installing any AgentExchange package into a production org, complete the following pre-installation checklist.

Step	Action
1	Confirm the installing user has the Download AgentExchange Packages permission (or is a full Salesforce/Slack admin).
2	Review the listing's compatibility notes (supported editions, API version, required licenses).
3	Check whether the package requires any pre-existing dependencies (connected apps, Named Credentials, external services).
4	Decide on an installation target: a sandbox for testing first, or production directly.
5	Review the publisher's security review status and permissions the package requests.
6	Notify affected teams of the planned install window, especially for packages that modify shared objects or page layouts.

CAUTION

Installing directly into a production org without first testing in a sandbox is not recommended for any package that modifies existing objects, automation, or page layouts. Even AgentExchange-vetted solutions can conflict with org-specific customizations.

4.1 Private Offers

Some partners extend private offers directly to a customer — custom pricing or bundling not shown on the public listing. Private offers arrive as a notification to the relevant account admin and are accepted through the same installation flow described in Section 5.

5. Installing an AgentExchange Package

Once pre-installation checks are complete, installation follows a consistent flow regardless of solution type.

- 1 **Locate the listing** and select Get It Now (free) or Buy Now (paid).
- 2 **Choose an install target** — a specific sandbox or production org connected to the account, or a specific Slack workspace.
- 3 **Review requested permissions.** The install screen displays what the package will access (objects, API scopes, connected services). Confirm this aligns with expectations before proceeding.
- 4 **Select an install-for option** — Install for Admins Only, Install for All Users, or Install for Specific Profiles — to control initial access.
- 5 **Confirm and install.** Salesforce provisions the package's components into the target environment. Installation time varies with package size and complexity.
- 6 **Verify installation** by checking Setup > Installed Packages (Salesforce) or the workspace's App Directory (Slack).

TIP

Choosing “Install for Admins Only” is a safer default for first-time installs of unfamiliar packages. It lets an admin validate behavior before extending access org-wide.

6. Handling Unauthorized or Unrecognized Packages

Salesforce periodically flags managed packages installed outside of standard admin review — for example, packages installed by a user with broader permissions than intended, or packages that haven't completed the AgentExchange security review. When this occurs:

- The org admin receives a notification identifying the package and the installing user.
- The admin can review the package's granted access from Setup > Installed Packages.
- Packages that fail review or are no longer needed can be uninstalled from the same screen.

CAUTION

Uninstalling a package removes its custom objects, fields, and data unless those components were cloned or extended independently. Export any data created by the package before uninstalling.

7. App Rollout and User Access Management

Installing a package makes it available in the org, but rollout — deciding who can actually use it — is a separate step.

7.1 Rollout Approaches

Approach	Best For
Phased rollout by profile or permission set	Larger orgs validating a solution with one team before wider release
Full rollout to all users	Simple utilities with low customization risk
Rollout via permission set groups	Solutions with multiple optional feature areas

7.2 License Management

Paid packages typically use Salesforce's License Management Org (LMO) framework, which lets the publisher track seat usage and expiration independent of the customer's own org. Admins can view assigned licenses and reassign seats from Setup > Installed Packages > License Management.

8. Accessing AgentExchange from Agentforce Builder

Because a large share of AgentExchange listings are agentic components rather than full applications, Salesforce surfaces AgentExchange directly inside Agentforce Builder. From within an agent's configuration screen, a builder can:

- Search AgentExchange for actions, topics, prompt templates, or agent templates relevant to the agent being built.
- Preview a component's description and requirements without leaving the builder.
- Install and immediately attach the component to the agent under construction.

This shortens the path from “I need my agent to do X” to a working component, without a separate marketplace-then-Setup round trip.

9. Post-Installation Tasks

Task	Why It Matters
Configure package-specific settings	Most packages expose a custom settings tab or Setup page that must be configured before first use.
Assign permission sets	Many packages ship permission sets rather than modifying profiles directly — these must be assigned explicitly.
Run the publisher's post-install checklist	Listings often link to setup documentation covering required configuration steps.
Validate in a sandbox before enabling in production	Confirms the package behaves as expected against org-specific data and automation.
Schedule a review date	Revisit installed packages periodically to confirm they're still in use and up to date.

10. Troubleshooting and FAQ

Q: The install button is greyed out or missing. Why?

This typically means the logged-in user lacks the Download AgentExchange Packages permission, or the listing isn't compatible with the org's current edition or API version. Confirm both before escalating.

Q: Installation is stuck in “In Progress.”

Large packages can take several minutes. If installation doesn't complete after an extended wait, check Setup > Installed Packages for an error status, and consult the publisher's support listing for known issues.

Q: A package I installed conflicts with existing automation.

Review the package's installed components against existing Flows, triggers, and validation rules on shared objects. Where possible, test the conflict in a sandbox and adjust order of execution or scope before resolving in production.

Q: Can I try a paid solution before purchasing?

Most paid listings offer either a test drive or a time-limited trial version. Both are configured by the publisher and indicated on the listing page.

Q: Who do I contact if a solution isn't working as expected?

Each listing includes publisher contact information and support resources. For issues with the AgentExchange platform itself (not a specific solution), use Salesforce's standard support channels.

PART II

Partner Publishing Guide

A step-by-step guide for ISV and consulting partners who want to build, package, and publish a solution on AgentExchange.

11. Becoming a Salesforce Partner

Publishing on AgentExchange requires enrollment in the Salesforce Partner Network under either the ISV (Independent Software Vendor) or Consulting track. For agentic solutions specifically, Salesforce runs a dedicated AgentExchange ISV Program Track.

- 1 **Sign up** through the Salesforce Partner Network, and enroll under the AgentExchange ISV Program Track for agent-based solutions.
- 2 **Submit a business plan** outlining the solution's value proposition and target market as part of corporate application review.
- 3 **Await approval** — corporate application review typically takes one to three weeks.
- 4 **Provision a Partner org**, connect an Environment Hub, and register a unique corporate namespace to isolate the partner's package components from others on the platform.

NOTE

A registered namespace is permanent for a given Partner org and cannot be reused across unrelated products. Choose it deliberately — it becomes part of every component's API name.

12. Building Agentic Components

AgentExchange solutions are built and developed inside a partner's scratch org or developer environment, then packaged for distribution. Salesforce expects solutions to follow an action-oriented architecture — that is, built as modular, composable building blocks that an autonomous agent can invoke, rather than passive user interfaces alone.

12.1 Component Types

Component	Purpose
Actions	Discrete tasks an agent can perform, built from Apex, Flow, or an external API/MCP server call.
Topics	Groupings of related actions and instructions that keep an agent focused on a specific job.
Prompt Templates	Reusable, pre-written prompt structures for consistent agent behavior in defined scenarios.
Agent Templates	Full agent configurations combining multiple topics and actions with global instructions.

NOTE

Beginning in April 2026, Salesforce's Agent Script documentation renamed Topics to Subagents (and the Topic Selector to Agent Router) to better reflect their role as specialized, focused agents. There is no functional change. AgentExchange listing terminology had not fully transitioned to "subagent" as of this writing, so this manual uses "topic" for consistency with current listing and Partner Console language, and readers should expect to see both terms in Salesforce's own documentation for some time.

12.2 Integration Requirements

- Solutions must plug directly into Agentforce Builder rather than operating as a fully separate interface.
- External integrations should be exposed through standard mechanisms — Apex, Flow, REST APIs, or Model Context Protocol (MCP) servers — so agents can invoke them predictably.
- Traditional (non-agentic) solutions — apps, Bolt solutions, Flow solutions, Lightning data — remain supported on AgentExchange under the original AppExchange packaging model.

13. Packaging and Security Review

13.1 Second-Generation Packaging (2GP)

Salesforce recommends Second-Generation Managed Packages (2GP) for all new AgentExchange apps. 2GP supports independent versioning, dependency management, and modular deployment. First-generation managed packages (1GP) remain supported for existing solutions, but new listings should default to 2GP unless a specific dependency requires otherwise.

- 1 Bundle solution metadata using Salesforce CLI (SFDX) into a 2GP package.
- 2 Upload a Beta version of the package for internal and Salesforce QA testing.
- 3 Promote the validated Beta to a Released state — sometimes referred to as the "Golden Package" — once testing is complete.

13.2 Security Review

Every package submitted to AgentExchange undergoes a mandatory security review before it can go live. This review evaluates the package's requested permissions, data handling, and code quality against Salesforce's security standards.

Item	Detail
Review trigger	Submission of a Released package version through the Partner Console
Typical review duration	Approximately 6–9 weeks for an initial submission
Fee (paid solutions)	Currently \$999 per submission
Fee (free solutions)	No charge
Subsequent updates	Minor updates may qualify for an expedited Self-Review Wizard rather than a full review cycle

CAUTION

Review timelines and fees are set by Salesforce and subject to change. Confirm current figures in the Partner Console before budgeting a release timeline.

14. Creating a Listing

Once a package has passed security review, the partner creates the public-facing listing using the Listing Builder inside the Partner Console.

- 1 Navigate to the Publishing Console and select the Listings tab.
- 2 Click New Listing and select the appropriate package type (app, agent component, Bolt solution, consulting service, etc.).
- 3 Write listing copy optimized for AgentExchange's semantic, intent-based search rather than traditional keyword-stuffing — clear, natural descriptions of what the solution does and who it's for perform better than keyword lists.
- 4 Add screenshots, a demo (optional but recommended), and category/industry tags.
- 5 Configure a test drive or trial, if offered.
- 6 Submit the listing for publication.

15. Pricing Models and Fees

AgentExchange supports several pricing structures, configured per listing:

Model	Description
Free	No cost to the customer; no listing fee to the partner.
Flat fee	A single one-time or recurring charge regardless of usage.
Per-user/per-month	Priced by number of licensed seats.
Usage-based	Priced against a defined usage metric (API calls, transactions, records processed).
Private offer	Custom pricing negotiated directly with a specific customer.

Partners can also use private offers and unified billing to shorten sales cycles — purchases are consolidated into the customer's existing Salesforce account, and automated provisioning grants access as soon as an offer is accepted, without a separate procurement step.

16. Managing Listings, Leads, and Analytics

After a listing goes live, ongoing management happens in the Partner Console:

- **Listings** — update descriptions, screenshots, and pricing; publish new package versions.
- **Company Info** — maintain the partner's public company profile shown across all listings.
- **Leads** — review customer interactions (test drives, inquiries, trial signups) captured through the listing.
- **Analytics** — track listing views, conversion, and installed-base metrics over time.
- **Notifications** — receive alerts for review status changes, security re-reviews, and policy updates.

TIP

Treat the Partner Console's Analytics tab as a standing agenda item, not a one-time check. Listings with declining view-to-install conversion often need refreshed screenshots or a demo update rather than a pricing change.

Appendix A — Glossary

Term	Definition
AgentExchange	Salesforce's unified marketplace combining AppExchange, the Slack Marketplace, and the Agentforce component ecosystem.
AppExchange	The predecessor marketplace for traditional Salesforce apps and components, now unified under AgentExchange.
Agentforce	Salesforce's platform for building and deploying autonomous AI agents.
Agentforce Builder	The in-product tool used to configure and assemble agents from topics, actions, and templates.
ISV	Independent Software Vendor — a partner track for companies building and distributing packaged software.
LMO	License Management Org — the framework partners use to track and manage customer license assignments.
MCP Server	Model Context Protocol server — a standardized external integration point an agent can call as an action.
Partner Console	The authenticated workspace for managing partner org connections, packages, and listings.
Publishing Console	The area of the Partner Console used specifically to create and submit listings.

Appendix B — Permission Reference Table

Permission	Grants	Typically Assigned To
Download AgentExchange Packages	Install packages into a Salesforce org	Admins; delegated installers
Create AgentExchange Packages	Build a publishable package in a partner org	Partner developers
Upload AgentExchange Packages	Submit a package/listing for publication	Partner release managers
Manage Listings	Access the Publishing tab in the Partner Community to create or update listings	Partner marketing/listing owners
Slack Workspace Admin	Install and manage Slack Marketplace solutions	Slack workspace owners/admins

NOTE

Permission names above reflect current AgentExchange platform documentation. Some orgs may still display the legacy label (“Download/Create/Upload AppExchange Packages”) in Setup while Salesforce completes the rebrand rollout — the underlying permission and its effect are unchanged either way. Manage Listings is a separate, Partner Community–level permission that governs access to the listing-authoring tools themselves, distinct from the package-level permissions above.

Appendix C — Support Resources

- Salesforce Application Installation Guide (developer.salesforce.com) — customer/admin install workflows
- Salesforce ISVforce Guide (developer.salesforce.com) — partner packaging and distribution
- Trailhead — AgentExchange Publishing for Partners module
- Partner Console — Notifications tab for policy and review-status updates
- Salesforce Trailblazer Community — peer support and best practices

End of document.